

Formal and semi-formal writing

Component 1 • Exercise 6 • 15 marks | syllabus 2027-2029

Learning focus

Write 120–160 words as an article, report, essay or review with purposeful structure and appropriate register.

Match form, reader and purpose

For an article, use a clear opening and engaging but controlled voice; for a report, describe findings and make a recommendation; for an essay, develop a position; for a review, assess an experience with examples. Follow the form specified in the rubric. Marks: content 6, language 9.

Worked example

A report for a principal should say what students used, what difficulties arose and what action would help. “Hi!” and “Awesome!” would not suit that audience.

Develop a balanced paragraph

Explain each idea using a reason or example instead of listing points. Use transitions to guide the reader; contrast a benefit with a realistic limit, then make a practical recommendation. Check subject-verb agreement and tenses.

Worked example

“The new tables provide a quiet place to work. However, they are often full at lunchtime. A booking system could make access fairer.”

Practice paper

Formal and semi-formal writing

Original FagusED practice. Answer on the lines provided. The number of marks is shown in square brackets.

Name: _____ Date: _____

Your school has opened a new study room. The principal asks you to write a short report on its first month. Include: what students find useful; one problem students have experienced; what the school could improve. Write 120–160 words.

[15] Content: 6; Language: 9.

The sample below addresses all three prompts and models a suitable register. Other well developed responses may also earn credit.

Marking focus

Content [6]: cover all three prompts and develop relevant ideas. Language [9]: range and accuracy of grammar and vocabulary, organisation and appropriate register. Verify 120–160 words and edit punctuation and spelling.

Assessment structure: Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (Count-in Speaking) 0511 syllabus for 2027–2029, <https://www.cambridgeinternational.org/Images/721343-2027-2029-syllabus.pdf>. Original passages, prompts and scripts by FagusED. June 2026 papers and mark schemes supplied by the user informed presentation. Independent practice material, not an official Cambridge paper.